Quiet Bounce

S&P +0.27% as equities stabilize. Oil disruptions persist—Brent above $100, diesel crosses $5. VIX eases to 22.38.

THE SESSION

Equities edged higher Tuesday as buyers emerged after last week's selling, though the session lacked real conviction. The S&P 500 added 0.27% to 6,717, the Dow rose 0.10%, and the Nasdaq gained 0.47%. Small-caps outpaced with the Russell 2000 up 0.67%. The VIX dipped 4.8% to 22.38—still elevated, but the first meaningful downtick in over a week.

The macro backdrop remains dominated by the Middle East conflict. Attacks on the UAE's Fujairah port and Shah gas field added to energy supply concerns, and Gulf states are pressing Washington to neutralize Iran's military capabilities as the Strait of Hormuz crisis deepens. US average diesel crossed $5 per gallon for the first time in this cycle, a real headwind for transportation and manufacturing margins. Brent crude held above $100. The number of US troops wounded in the conflict has risen to approximately 200.

Despite those headwinds, today's bounce felt more like short-covering and positioning than a fundamental shift. Volume was unremarkable. Semiconductors showed relative strength—Lam Research up 3.2%, TSM up 1.7%—ahead of Nvidia's GTC conference. Energy names benefited from the sustained crude bid. Defensives were mixed, with Lockheed Martin off 1.4% even as geopolitical tensions escalate.

Gold added 0.16% and continues to trade around $5,010. Bitcoin slipped 0.5% to $74,520, largely range-bound as digital assets consolidate near recent levels.

IOWN Tactical: The S&P remains well within its normal range relative to the 200-day moving average. No tactical signals triggered. We continue to own quality and collect dividends through the volatility.

IOWN HOLDINGS: NOTABLE MOVERS

WINNERS

FINV +12.57% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

The Chinese fintech surged on strong quarterly results and positive guidance, extending its run as one of the portfolio's top performers this year.

ATAT +5.98% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Atour Lifestyle continued its momentum. The Chinese hotel operator has been a standout in the Growth Portfolio, benefiting from China's domestic travel recovery.

COIN +3.40% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Coinbase rallied alongside broader crypto sentiment. The digital-credit strategy at MicroStrategy also drew attention to crypto-adjacent business models.

LRCX +3.22% DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Lam Research led the Dividend Strategy higher, catching a bid with the broader semiconductor group ahead of Nvidia's GTC 2026 conference.

HOOD +2.71% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Robinhood extended recent gains as retail trading volumes remain healthy and the company benefits from crypto product expansion.

MATX +2.53% DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Matson benefited from elevated shipping rates driven by energy-related supply chain disruptions in the Middle East.

DECLINERS

GFI –1.96% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Gold Fields gave back ground despite gold holding near $5,010. South African miners traded weaker as the rand strengthened.

FTNT –1.57% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Fortinet drifted lower in a broad cybersecurity pullback. Cisco's edge-AI partnership with Nvidia drew attention to competitive dynamics in the space.

LMT –1.37% DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Lockheed Martin pulled back modestly after its recent run. Defense stocks have been strong amid the Middle East conflict; today's move looks like routine profit-taking.

GPC –1.14% DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Genuine Parts continued its difficult 2026, down 15% year-to-date. Auto parts demand remains soft amid consumer spending caution.

STLD –0.95% DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Steel Dynamics softened on broader concern that elevated energy costs will compress industrial margins.

HOLDINGS NEWS

NVDA — GTC 2026 Conference. Nvidia's annual GPU Technology Conference begins this week. Investors are watching for updates on the Blackwell and Vera Rubin architectures, with analysts projecting the sales opportunity for Blackwell and Rubin chips at over $1 trillion by 2027. The stock was down 0.70% today to $181.93, positioning ahead of the event.

CVX — Ipiranga Stake. Chevron is reportedly in advanced negotiations to acquire a 30% stake in Ipiranga, the Brazilian fuel distribution business. CVX rose 0.57% to $197.97. The deal would expand Chevron's downstream presence in Latin America.

SYK — MedTech Cyber Incident. Stryker was referenced in reports about a cyberattack affecting medical technology companies. The stock was essentially flat at $349.11, down just 0.13%, suggesting the market views the impact as limited.

PORTFOLIO PERFORMANCE

DIVIDEND STRATEGY ✓ BEAT ONE

+0.31%

vs. DVY –0.19% | IWS +0.80%

GROWTH PORTFOLIO ✓ BEAT

+1.16%

vs. IUSG +0.22%

YEAR-TO-DATE

Dividend +6.36% vs DVY +6.89% / IWS +3.10%

Growth +0.41% vs IUSG –4.27%